वेदाक्षर स्वरूपं (Form Of The Vēdākshara)

Abstract

This study explores the metaphysical and linguistic essence of the *Akshara* (Vēdākshara) as presented in the Vēdic tradition. It distinguishes between the Vēdic and Sanskrit languages, asserting that while Sanskrit evolved from the Vēdic tongue, the two differ fundamentally in grammar, structure, and spiritual function. The Vēdas, described as *Chhandas* (metrical and prosodic in nature), are identified as the only authentic source of the original divine language. The paper explains that in the Vēdas, language is *Vēdākshara-centered* (*Akshara-pradhāna*), whereas in later human languages, it becomes *sound- and root-centered* (*Shabda-dhātu-pradhāna*).

Through scriptural references, we established that Vēdāksharas (*Aksharās*) emerge at the intersection of vital, life, and sound energies, while words arise from the union of desire, emotion, and effort. Thus, the *Akshara* embodies the inner vital consciousness of beings, while words express external sensory experiences. The analysis concludes that *Akshara* represents the metaphysical principle sustaining life and consciousness, whereas words and sounds manifest human knowledge and emotional expression.

Introduction:

In the worldly sense, a *Vēdākshara* is defined as a “complete sound form” that emerges from the lips, whether it occurs within one *matra* (unit of time) or two. Every language in the world has its own alphabet, with a fixed number of letters. However, in some languages, letters do not possess independent significance or full integrity; their pronunciation is incomplete or merely symbolic.

Discussion:

The Vēdas stand supreme, comprehensive, perfect, vast, and ancient among all forms of knowledge and literature. Indian scholars have always proclaimed this truth. Western scholars have only hinted at it. Linguists, literary theorists, and philosophers agree that the *Vēdic language* is the first complete language. From it, *Sanskrit* took shape. Yet, these two are distinct in form, grammar, and purpose [Method-1, Ref (1)]. This matter requires thorough investigation. Though they share some similarities in sound and vocabulary, they remain fundamentally different. Their resemblance only reinforces the belief that the Vēdic and Sanskrit languages are closely related.

There are several reasons for this view:
All major commentaries, grammatical treatises, and explanations of the Vēdas are written in Sanskrit. Many Vēdic words appear in Sanskrit usage. The ancient grammarian *Panini* studied both Vēdic and Sanskrit grammar in Sanskrit itself. When distinguishing the two, Panini explained that *“Vēda is Chandasa (prosody* or metrical arrangement),” meaning the Vēdic language is distinct and that “Chhandas” is another name for the Vēdic tongue.

The *Vēda Samhitas* are the only authoritative texts of the Vēdic language; there is no second scripture [Method-2, Ref (2)]. Before the emergence of Sanskrit, all sacred and literary expressions existed in the Vēdic language. The Vēda is boundless. While the Vēdic language arose naturally as the vehicle of spiritual expression, later languages, including Sanskrit, are human creations.

In the Vēdas, language is *“Vēdākshara-centered” (akshara-pradhāna)* [Method-3, Ref (3)], while in ordinary languages, it is *“sound and root-centered” (Shabda-dhātu-pradhāna)*. At both levels, the fundamental building block of language is the *Vēdākshara*.

Through *the use of Vēdāksharas*, the vital life energy (*prāna shakti*) gains the form of *speech (vāg-rupa)* [Method-4, Ref (4)]. Through *the use of words (Shabda)*, human emotions and desires are expressed. When a Vēdākshara's (Akshara) position changes, its energetic form changes.

When a word's root changes, its meaning changes. Vēdāksharas are natural to living beings [Method-5, Ref (5)]; words are human constructs. A Vēdākshara is expressed as sound through the vital breath (*prāna*) [Method-6, Ref (6)], while a word becomes language through human will and meaning.

The grammar of Vēdāksharas is the process through which life transforms into speech. The grammar of human language, on the other hand, gives form and completeness to networks of sounds and meanings. The *meaning of a Vēdākshara* differs from that of a *word* or *root*. The birth of a Vēdākshara occurs where *life energy, vital energy, and sound energy* meet [Method-7, Ref (7)].

The birth of a word occurs where *desire, feeling, and effort* converge [Method-8, Ref (8)]. A Vēdākshara represents the inner vital power of the body [Method-9, Ref (9)], while a word represents the external sensory experience [Method-10, Ref (10)]. A Vēdākshara is the stabilized form of consciousness; a word is the manifest form of meaning. Within the domain of life, *Vēdāksharas arise*; within the domain of feeling, *sounds arise*. The power of Vēdāksharas is common to all living beings; the power of words and roots belongs only to humans [Method-11, Ref (11)]. Vēdāksharas signal the beginning of life; languages express the realization of knowledge and emotion. Vēdākshara power extends life [Method-12, Ref (12)]; sound power expands knowledge. A Vēdākshara is metaphysical; sound and language serve knowledge expression.

Methods:

Method-1:

Vēdic language is the first complete language. From it, *Sanskrit* took shape. Yet, these two are distinct in form

YajurVēdā (7-14)
देवता: विश्वेदेवा ऋषि: वत्सार काश्यप छन्द: विराड् जगती स्वर: निषादः
अच्छिन्नस्य ते देव सोम सुवीर्यस्य रायस्पोषस्य ददितारः स्याम।
सा प्रथमा सँस्कृतिर्विश्ववारा स प्रथमो वरुणो मित्रोऽअग्निः ।।

Essence of YajurVēdā (7-14)
The Supreme Being (Paramātma) is the primordial one; He existed before all. From Him emerged speech, that is, the Vēda, the sacred words, or the language of the Vēdas, which is the first of all languages. That Vēda bestows every kind of prosperity and wealth.
O Lord! O Soma! For the sake of Your sacred knowledge of the Vēda,
may we become valiant like Varuṇa, rich in learning and wealth like Agni,
and generous in giving like Mitra!

Proposition
Question: Which is the first language?
Answer: The language of the Vēdas or Vēdic speech, as stated in the YajurVēda (7-14).

Question: What is indivisible?
Answer: The Vēdic language, according to the YajurVēda (7-14).

Question: Did Sanskrit originate from the Vēdic language?
Answer: Yes, it did. In YajurVēda (7-14), it is said, “May we, like Mitra or Vāyu (RigVēda 3-59-9), be givers of offerings.” Just as Vāyu refines and purifies all substances, so too should we refine the Vēdic language and offer it as Sanskrit, the language of purity and refinement.

Conclusion of Method-1:
It is evident from YajurVēda (7-14) that Sanskrit language developed from the Vēdic language. Based on YajurVēda (7-14), it can be demonstrated that Vēda was the first language of humans, and Sanskrit language, containing those words, originated from it.

Method-2:

The *Vēda Samhitas* are the only authoritative texts of the Vēdic language, there is no second scripture for the Vēdic language, the “Vēda Saṃhitā” is a single text.

RigVēdā (1-165-15)

देवता: इन्द्र: ऋषि: अगस्त्य: छन्द: पङ्क्ति: स्वर: पञ्चम:
ए॒ष व॒: स्तोमो॑ मरुत इ॒यं गीर्मा॑न्दा॒र्यस्य॑ मा॒न्यस्य॑ का॒रोः।
एषा या॑सीष्ट त॒न्वे व॒यां वि॒द्यामे॒ष व॒ज्रन जी॒रदा॑नुम् ॥

Essence of RigVēdā (1-165-15):

The **Vēda Saṃhitā** coming from **the Lord (Bhagavān)** contains the speech of the one worthy of worship, that is, of the **Maruts**, and of the one who is venerable, that is, **Indra**. By desiring the praise of **Indra, the dēvatā**, the wind (vāyu) spreads it to us. We receive the desire of the wind from all directions. It comes so that we may **shed our sins and attain the knowledge of truth**.

Proposition:

Question: What is the desire of the winds in RigVēda (1-165-15)?
Answer: To perform Praises (hymns).

Question: Who is praising?
Answer: Sage Agastya.

Question: About whom is Agastya praising?
Answer: About the Lord (Bhagavān), the worthy of praise, and the venerable.

Question: Who is the worthy of praise?
Answer: The Maruts.

Question: Who is the venerable?
Answer: Indra is the venerable.

Question: What does Agastya wish for us?
Answer: The Vēda.

Question: How do Agastya's desires reach us?
Answer: Agastya's desire spreads in all directions through the Maruts, praising it.

Question: Who can receive Agastya's praises?
Answer: Only those humans who shed their sins receive the knowledge of the Vēda.

Question: What do we learn fundamentally from RigVēda (1-165-15)?
Answer: Vēdic mantras came from the Lord. Through the praises of the sages, they spread via the Maruts and reach those who have shed their sins. Therefore, for the Vēdic language, the Vēda Saṃhitā is a single text.

Conclusion of Method-2:
To establish that the **Vēdic language has the Vēda Saṃhitā as its only text**, the essence of RigVēda (1-165-15) has been presented and demonstrated.

Method-3:

In the Vēdas, language is *"Vēdākshara-centered" (akshara-pradhāna,* while in ordinary languages, it is *"sound and root-centered" (Shabda-dhātu-pradhāna)*

RigVēdā (9-28-2)

देवता: पवमानः सोमः ऋषि: प्रियमेधः छन्द: विराड्गायत्री स्वर: षड्जः
एष पवित्रे अक्षरत्सोमो देवेभ्य: सुतः । विश्वा धामान्याविशन् ॥

Essence of RigVēdā (9-28-2):

In the Vēdas, language is **"Vēdākshara-centered" (akṣara-pradhāna)** — this mantra reveals that **Soma**, as the power of knowledge, stands as the offspring of the dēvatās (Scholars), flowing for the sake of purity. He enters all bodies on the earth and sanctifies them.
Through the influence of this **Soma sacrifice (Soma-yajña)**, the dēvatās (Scholars) purify the bodies and guide beings toward a higher way of life.
Therefore, this mantra emphasizes that in the Vēdas, language is **based on the power of the akṣara** — each **akṣara** carries divine energy and leads human beings toward divinity.

Proposition:

Question: In this mantra (RigVēda 9-28-2), how do we know that *"eṣaḥ"* means "Vēdākshara (*akṣara*)"?
Answer: In this mantra (RigVēda 9-28-2), the seer (*ṛṣi*) is *Priyamedha*, which means "one who possesses a mind with the power of desirable concentration." Knowledge is sustained by the intellect, and **the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*) itself is knowledge**. Therefore, what is sustained by the intellect is called *akṣara* (the Vēdākshara).

Question: What is the relationship between Soma and the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*)?
Answer: Soma **is** the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*).

Question: In this mantra (RigVēda 9-28-2), what purifies?
Answer: In this mantra (RigVēda 9-28-2), the dēvatā (*dēvatā*) is *Pavamāna Soma*. Therefore, **Soma himself is the purifier**.

Question: Whom does he purify?
Answer: The *dēvatās (Scholars).*

Question: How does he purify them?
Answer: By flowing as their offspring — that is, by flowing in the form of knowledge.

Question: What do the *dēvatās (Scholars)* do with that knowledge?
Answer: The *dēvatās (Scholars)*, with that knowledge, enter the bodies on earth and purify them, meaning, they enlighten human beings with divine knowledge and make them pure.

Conclusion of Method-3:
In the Vēdas, language is **"Vēdākshara-centered" (akṣara-pradhāna)**. These mantras tell us that **Soma**, as the power in the form of knowledge, stands as the offspring of the *dēvatās (Scholars)*, flows for the sake of purity, and enters all bodies on the earth, sanctifying them.

Method-4:

Through *the use of Vēdāksharas*, the vital life energy (*prāna shakti*) gains the form of *speech (vāg-rupa).*

RigVēdā (10-125-4)

देवता: वागाम्भृणी ऋषि: वागाम्भृणी छन्द: त्रिष्टुप् स्वर: धैवतः
मया॒ सो अन्न॑मत्ति॒ यो वि॒पश्य॑ति॒ यः प्राणि॑ति॒ य ईं॑ शृ॒णोत्यु॒क्तम् । अ॒म॒न्तवो॒ मां त उप॑ क्षियन्ति श्रु॒धि श्रु॑त श्रद्धि॒वं ते॑ वदामि ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-125-4):
Whoever eats food and breathes in and out - to such people, the **Vēda**, which is a subject filled with devotion and reverence, is taught by the **Supreme Being (Paramātma)** Himself. Such individuals, endowed with these two powers - **food (vital energy)** and **breath (life force)**, become intelligent and are able to understand the Vēda and express creativity.
Those who accept the Vēda in an opposing or contradictory manner cannot realize the Supreme Being. Likewise, those who reject the teacher who imparts Vēdic knowledge are, in fact, rejecting the Supreme Being Himself.
For this mantra, the **dēvatā (dēvatā)** and **seer (ṛṣi)** are *Vāgāmbṛṇī* — that is, *Vāk + Āmbṛṇī*.

- *Vāk* means **speech**.
- *Āmbṛṇī* means **daughter of Ambṛṇa**, who is **Sarasvatī**.

Therefore, the phrase **"by me"** in this mantra refers to **"by the *dēvatā*"**, and the phrase **"by you"** refers to **"by the seer."**

Proposition
Question: Who revealed the Vēda?
Answer: According to RigVēda (10-125-4), the one who gave the Vēda is *Vāgāmbṛṇī*.

Question: Who is Vāgāmbṛṇī?
Answer: Vāk.

Question: To whom was this Vāk revealed?
Answer: To those who eat food, who breathe in and out, and who possess intellect.

Question: Who has intellect?
Answer: According to this mantra (RigVēda 10-125-4), the seer (*ṛṣi*) is *Vāgāmbṛṇī*. That is, those who possess Vāk have intellect.

Question: What is the fundamental result of giving the Vēda to those with intellect?
Answer: They observe and listen with discernment.

Question: What does “observe with discernment” mean?
Answer: It means observing not merely with the eyes but with the intellect.

Question: What does eating food mean?
Answer: When a human eats food, it is equivalent to performing a yajña for sustaining the life force (*prāṇāgni*).

Question: What happens by eating food?
Answer: Through the food eaten, one obtains life energy and intellect.
Question: What happens through the use of Vēdāksharas?
Answer: Through the use of Vēdāksharas, the life fire (*prāṇāgni*) and speech fire (*vāgāgni*) manifest in the being.

Question: What happens through breathing in and out?
Answer: Through inhalation and exhalation, the life force maintains the being’s vitality.
According to RigVēda (1.1.4), the yajña performed with fire (*agni*) must be non-violent, and the Supreme Being (*Paramātma*) is attained only by the wise. That is, human food must be **non-violent**.

Conclusion of Method-4: From the Mantra RigVēda (10-125-4), it is evident that “through *the use of Vēdāksharas (Aksharās)*, the vital life energy (*prāna shakti*) gains the form of *speech (vāg-rupa)”.*

Method-5:
Vēdāksharas are natural to living beings; words are human constructs.

YajurVēdā(9-31)

देवता: अग्न्यादयो मन्त्रोक्ता देवताः ऋषि: तापस ऋषिः छन्द: स्वराड् अति धृतिः स्वर: षड्जः
अ॒ग्निरेका॑क्षरणे प्रा॒णमु॑दजय॒त् तमुज्जे॑षम॒श्विनौ॒ द्व्य॑क्षरेण द्वि॒पदौ॑ मनु॒ष्या॑नु॑दजयतां॒ तानुज्जे॑षं॒ विष्णु॒स्त्र्य॑क्षरेण॒ त्रील्ँलो॒कानु॑दजय॒त् तानुज्जे॑षं॒ सोम॒श्चतु॑रक्षरेण॒ चतु॑ष्पदः प॒शूनु॑दजय॒त् तानुज्जे॑षम् ॥३१॥

YajurVēdā(9-32)

देवता: पूषादयो मन्त्रोक्ता देवताः ऋषि: तापस॒ ऋषिः छन्द: कृतिः स्वर: निषादः
पू॒षा पञ्चा॑क्षरेण॒ पञ्च॒ दिश॒ऽउ॑दजय॒त् ताऽउज्जेष॑ सवि॒ता षड॑क्षरेण॒ षड् ऋ॒तूनु॑दजय॒त् तानुज्जे॑षं म॒रुतः स॒प्ताक्ष॑रेण स॒प्त ग्रा॒म्यान् प॒शूनु॑दजयँ॒स्तानुज्जे॑षं॒ बृह॒स्पति॑र॒ष्टाक्ष॑रेण गाय॒त्रीमु॑दजय॒त् तामुज्जे॑षम् ॥३२॥

Essence of YajurVēda (9-31 and 9-32):

- **Agni** with a single Vēdākshara, or with a single-Vēdākshara divine **Gayatri meter**, gave birth to the life force (*prāṇa*). He received it in the best manner.
- **Ashvins** with two Vēdāksharas, or with a two-Vēdākshara divine **Ushnik meter**, gave birth to humans and birds that move with two legs. They received all of them in the best manner.
- **Vishnu** with three Vēdāksharas, or with a three-Vēdākshara divine **Anushtup meter**, gave birth to the three worlds. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Soma** with four Vēdāksharas, or with a four-Vēdākshara divine **Brihati meter**, gave birth to animals that move with four legs. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Pushan** with five Vēdāksharas, or with a five-Vēdākshara divine **Pankti meter**, gave birth to the five directions. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Savita** with six Vēdāksharas, or with a six-Vēdākshara divine **Trishtup meter**, gave birth to the six seasons. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Maruts** with seven Vēdāksharas, or with a seven-Vēdākshara divine **Jagati meter**, gave birth to seven village animals. They received all of them in the best manner.

- **Brihaspati** with eight Vēdāksharas, or with an eight-Vēdākshara Gayatri **meter**, gave birth to her that protects the one who chants. He received her in the best manner.

This passage describes how the *dēvatās (Scholars)*, through specific **Vēdāksharas and Vēdic meters (chandas)**, manifest life, directions, seasons, animals, and beings, each receiving them in the most perfect or auspicious way.

Proposition
Question: Is a Vēdākshara a living entity?
Answer: Yes, as can be understood from the Yajur Vēda (9-31) and Yajur Vēda (9-32) mantras.

Question: What is Prāṇa (life force)?
Answer: The five vital airs (pañcha prāṇas). They are Vyāna, Samāna, Udāna, Apāna, and Prāṇa.

Question: Who generated Prāṇa?
Answer: Agni generated Prāṇa and obtained it in its most excellent form.

Question: What does "obtaining in the most excellent form" mean?
Answer: It means obtaining completely or fully, as understood from Yajur Vēda (9-31).

Question: What does "Dvipadaḥ" mean?
Answer: Birds and humans.

Question: What are animals (paśū)?
Answer: Creatures that live in the forest; dogs and cats are also included.

Question: What are the seven domestic animals (Saptagrāmyān paśū)?
Answer: The seven village/domestic animals — cow, buffalo, horse, donkey, camel, goat, sheep.

Conclusion of Method-5:
A Vēdākshara is a group of living entities, as stated in Yajur Vēda (9-31) and Yajur Vēda (9-32).

Method-6:
A Vēdākshara is expressed as sound through the vital breath (*prāna*).

YajurVēdā(9-31)
देवता: अग्न्यादयो मन्त्रोक्ता देवताः ऋषि: तापस ऋषिः छन्द: स्वराड् अति धृतिः स्वर: षड्जः
अग्निरेकाक्षरणे प्राणमुदजयत् तमुज्जेषमश्विनौ द्व्यक्षरेण द्विपदौ मनुष्यानुदजयतां तानुज्जेषं विष्णुस्त्र्यक्षरेण त्रीँल्लोकानुदजयत् तानुज्जेषं सोमश्चतुरक्षरेण चतुष्पदः पशूनुदजयत् तानुज्जेषम् ॥३१॥

Essence of YajurVēda(9-31)
- **Agni** with a single Vēdākshara, or with a single-Vēdākshara divine **Gayatri meter**, gave birth to the life force (*prāṇa*). He received it in the best manner.
- **Ashvins** with two Vēdāksharas, or with a two-Vēdākshara divine **Ushnik meter**, gave birth to humans and birds that move with two legs. They received all of them in the best manner.
- **Vishnu** with three Vēdāksharas, or with a three-Vēdākshara divine **Anushtup meter**, gave birth to the three worlds. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Soma** with four Vēdāksharas, or with a four-Vēdākshara divine **Brihati meter**, gave birth to animals that move with four legs. He received all of them in the best manner.

Proposition:

Agni, with one Vēdākshara or syllable, in the divine Gayatri meter, generated Prāṇa (life force) and obtained it in its most excellent form.

Question: Does a Vēdākshara, using the life-breath (prāṇa vāyu), manifest as sound (nāda)?
Answer: Yes, as understood from Yajur Vēda (9-31).

Question: How did Agni generate Prāṇa?
Answer: When "Agni" is filled in vāyu, it transforms into Prāṇa.

Conclusion of Method-6:
It has been established, with the support of Yajur Vēda (9-31), a Vēdākshara is expressed as sound through the vital breath (*prāna*).

Method-7:
The birth of a Vēdākshara occurs where *life energy, vital energy, and sound energy* meet.

RigVēdā (1-101-5):
देवता**:** इन्द्रः ऋषि**:** कुत्स आङ्गिरसः छन्द**:** विराड्जगती स्वर**:** निषादः
यो विश्वस्य जगतः प्राणतस्पतिर्यो ब्रह्मणे प्रथमो गा अविन्दत्। इन्द्रो यो दस्यूँरधराँ अवातिरन्मरुत्वन्तं सख्याय हवामहे ॥

Essence of RigVēdā (1-101-5):
Those who first praised and attained the Supreme Being, the lord of all life forces of the entire universe, are called **Indra**.
Those who easily overcome enemies (the groups of Kāma, Krodha, Mada, Mātsarya), and the lowly (adharma, untruth, injustice),
Those who possess qualities like the air-lightness, mobility, conduciveness (to scent, sound, and heat), enlivening beings through the prāṇāyāma of life, and maintaining equilibrium (samyamanam). We invite such beings for friendship.

Proposition:

Question: Who is the life energy-vital energy?
Answer: Both life energy and vital energy is the Supreme Being, as made clear by RigVēda (1-101-5).

Question: What is sound energy (nāda śakti)?
Answer: From RigVēda (1-101-5), it is understood that the act of praising corresponds to sound energy.

Question: How is praising considered sound energy?
Answer: Sound energy is "Om" (Ōmkāra). Praise always begins with "Om."

Question: How is it known that the place where life energy, vital energy, and sound energy meet is the birthplace of a Vēdākshara?
Answer: In RigVēda (1-101-5), it is clearly indicated that praising (i.e., the sound energy) the Supreme Being, who is life energy and vital energy, results in their combination. This combination manifests as "Indra," and this Indra is the "Vēdākshara" (akshara).

Conclusion of Method-7:
It is established through RigVēda (1-101-5) that the place where life energy (jīva śakti), vital energy (prāṇa śakti), and sound energy (nāda śakti) come together is the birthplace of a Vēdākshara.

Method-8:

The birth of a word occurs where *desire, feeling, and effort* converge.

YajurVēdā (9-33)
देवता: मित्रादयो मन्त्रोक्ता देवताः ऋषि: तापस ऋषिः छन्द: कृतिः स्वर: निषादः
मि॒त्रो नवा॑क्षरेण त्रि॒वृत॒ स्तोम॒मुद॑जय॒त् तमु॒ज्जेष॑ं॒ वरु॑णो॒ दशा॑क्षरेण वि॒राज॒मुद॑जय॒त् तामु॒ज्जेष॒मिन्द्र॒ऽएका॑दशाक्षरेण त्रि॒ष्टुभ॒मुद॑जय॒त् तामु॒ज्जेष॑ं॒ विश्वे॑ दे॒वा द्वाद॑शाक्षरेण॒ जग॑ती॒मुद॑जय॒ँस्तामु॒ज्जेष॑म् ॥३३॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (9-33):
- **Mitra**, with nine Vēdāksharas, in the **Yajushi Brihati** meter, generated desire, thought, effort, and praise, and obtained them in their most excellent form.
- **Varuna**, with ten Vēdāksharas, in the **Yajushi Virat** meter, generated radiance, and obtained it in its most excellent form.
- **Indra**, with twelve Vēdāksharas, in the **Asuri Panktishchandas** meter, generated the day that remains in the three realms and obtained it in its most excellent form.
- **Vishvēdēvas**, with twelve Vēdāksharas, in the **Samani Gayatri** meter, generated the world (jagatī) and obtained it in its most excellent form.

Proposition:

Question: Is the place where “desire-thought-effort” come together the birthplace of a word or Vēdākshara (akṣara-pada)?
Answer: Yes, as understood from Yajur Vēda (9-33).

Question: What does “Trivṛtam” mean?
Answer: Desire (karma), thought (jñāna), and effort (upāsana).

Question: What does “Stotram” mean?
Answer: Stotram means praise. Praise means appreciating virtues and qualities. In YajurVēda (9-33), praise is being offered for Mitra. By following Mitra’s virtues, we correct and refine our own qualities, and our desires are involved in this process. Desires are thoughts, and they constitute our inner reflections.

Question: What is the inner connection of desire-thought-effort? Is the place where they come together the birthplace of a word or Vēdākshara (akṣara-pada)?
Answer: Only when there is desire does a person perform action; only when there is thought does knowledge arise; without effort, worship cannot be performed. Therefore, humans accomplish these through the mind. That is why the place where desire, thought, and effort come together is the birthplace of a word or Vēdākshara (akṣara-pada). This is our mind, as revealed by Yajur Vēda (9-33).

Conclusion of Method-8:
It is established, with the support of Yajur Vēda (9-33), that the place where “desire-thought-effort” come together is the birthplace of a word or Vēdākshara (akṣara-pada).

Method-9:
A Vēdākshara represents the inner vital power of the body.

YajurVēdā (9-31)
देवता: अग्न्यादयो मन्त्रोक्ता देवताः ऋषि: तापस ऋषिः छन्द: स्वराड् अति धृतिः स्वर: षड्जः
अ॒ग्निरेका॑क्षरणे प्रा॒णमुद॑जय॒त् तमु॒ज्जेष॑म॒श्विनौ॒ द्व्य॑क्षरेण द्वि॒पदौ॑ मनु॒ष्या॑नुद॑जयतां॒ तानु॒ज्जेष॑ं॒ विष्णु॒स्त्र्य॑क्षरेण॒ त्रील्ँ॑लो॒कानुद॑जय॒त् तानु॒ज्जेष॑ं॒ सोम॒श्चतु॑रक्षरेण॒ चतु॑ष्पदः प॒शूनुद॑जय॒त् तानु॒ज्जेष॑म् ॥३१॥

Essence of YajurVēdā (9-31):

- **Agni** with a single Vēdākshara, or with a single-Vēdākshara divine **Gayatri meter**, gave birth to the life force (*prāṇa*). He received it in the best manner.
- **Ashvins** with two Vēdāksharas, or with a two-Vēdākshara divine **Ushnik meter**, gave birth to humans and birds that move with two legs. They received all of them in the best manner.
- **Vishnu** with three Vēdāksharas, or with a three-Vēdākshara divine **Anushtup meter**, gave birth to the three worlds. He received all of them in the best manner.
- **Soma** with four Vēdāksharas, or with a four-Vēdākshara divine **Brihati meter**, gave birth to animals that move with four legs. He received all of them in the best manner.

Proposition:

Question: Who are the deities beginning with Agni (Agnyādayo dēvatāḥ)?
Answer: The deities such as Agni and others.

Question: Who generated the life force (Prāṇa)?
Answer: Agni, with one syllable, using the divine Gāyatrī meter, generated the life force in its most excellent form.

Question: Who obtained that life force?
Answer: Agni obtained that life force in its most excellent form.

Conclusion of Method-9:
According to YajurVēdā (9-31)mantra it has been established that the *Vēdākshara (akṣara)* is an internal power or energy within the human body.

Method-10:
A word represents the external sensory experience.

RigVēdā (1-62-2)
देवता: इन्द्रः ऋषि: नोधा गौतमः छन्द: निचृदार्षीत्रिष्टुप् स्वर: धैवतः
प्र वो॑ म॒हे मही॒ नमो॑ भरध्वमाङ्गू॒ष्यं॑ शवसा॒नाय॒ साम॑। येना॑ नः॒ पूर्वे॑ पि॒तरः॑ पद॒ज्ञा अर्च॑न्तो॒ अङ्गि॑रसो॒ गा अवि॑न्दन् ॥

Essence of RigVēdā (1-62-2):
O protectors! Among you, those who know the sacred word and the knowledge of the divine priest's speech, the elderly Gandharvas, in the festival, for that which is strong, loudly sing and praise the Sāma hymns, and they bow deeply with great reverence.

Proposition:

Question: Who are the ones that perform *Sāma-gāna* (the chanting of Sāma hymns)?
Answer: The Gandharvas.

Question: What is *Sāma-gāna*?
Answer: The hymns (*ṛks*) that are sung with melody and imagination (*ūhādi-gāna*) are called *Sāma-gāna*.

Question: What did the ancients do for strength?
Answer: They conducted festivals, which are external sensory experiences.

Question: What kind of speech or words does the divine priest of the dēvatās (scholars) possess?
Answer: Speech or words endowed with Vēdic knowledge.

Question: For what purpose did the ancients offer praise?
Answer: They praised for strong emotional energy (*bhāva-śakti*) or for protection and external sensory experience.

Question: Who is the one who bears or performs the act of salutation (*namaskāra*)?
Answer: The forefather, Brahmā, is the one who bears the salutation.

Conclusion of RigVēda (1-62-2):
It has been established with the help of the RigVēda (1-62-2) Mantra that a word represents the external sensory experience.

Method-11:

The power of Vēdāksharas is common to all living beings; the power of words and roots belongs only to humans.

RigVēda (1-34-6)

देवता: अश्विनौ ऋषि: हिरण्यस्तूप आङ्गिरसः छन्द: विराड्जगती स्वर: निषादः
त्रिर्नो अश्विना दिव्यानि भेषजा त्रिः पार्थिवानि त्रिरु दत्तमद्भ्यः । ओमानं शंयोर्ममकाय सूनवे त्रिधातु शर्म वहतं शुभस्पती ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-34-6):
O Ashvini Devas, givers of health, happiness, and auspiciousness!
May you grant to us and to our descendants the three kinds of creations made by Brahma for our protection:

1. Divine medicines (connected to the heavens),
2. Earthly medicinal substances (related to plants and herbs), and
3. Health-giving waters

May these bestow health and protection upon us!
And may you also grant the three *dhātus* (essences) - the metallic elements and the linguistic and spiritual elements (such as sound, intellect, and consciousness) - through which knowledge flows and manifests!

Proposition:

Question: In RigVēda (1-34-6), the deities are the Ashvins. According to this mantra, who are the two, or what are the two?
Answer: In RigVēda (1-34-6), there are two sages-Hiranyastūpa and Āṅgirasa. These two are the Ashvins-or symbolically, the two Ashvins represent *Gold (Hiranya)* and *Fire (Agni).*

Question: According to RigVēda (1-34-6), what do these Ashvins do, or what do these two represent?
Answer: These Ashvins provide healing from disease, fearlessness, and protection.

Question: How do these Ashvins provide healing from disease?
Answer: They prepare three kinds of divine medicines, through which healing and relief from disease are granted.

Question: What are the three kinds of divine medicines mentioned in RigVēda (1-34-6)?
Answer: The three kinds of solar rays, the three types of earthly substances, and the three kinds of waters.

Question: What are the three kinds of solar rays?
Answer: The rays of sunrise, noon, and sunset.

Question: What are the three types of earthly substances?
Answer: Gold, silver, and copper.

Question: What are the three kinds of waters?
Answer: Rainwater, fruit juices, and the sap of the Soma creeper.

Question: What are the three *Dhātus* (roots or grammatical bases) mentioned in RigVēda (1-34-6)?
Answer: *Parasmaipada*, *Ātmanepada*, and *Ubhayapada* forms.

Question: What is attained through these three *Dhātus*?
Answer: Bliss (ānanda) is attained.

Question: Who attains this bliss?
Answer: We and our descendants.

Question: How do the *Parasmaipada*, *Ātmanepada*, and *Ubhayapada* roots grant bliss?
Answer: Through these three *Dhātus*, language is formed; through language, knowledge arises; and through knowledge, bliss is attained. This bliss belongs exclusively to human beings.
Question: What do you intend to propose through this mantra?
Answer: Through the Ashvins, we gain knowledge of medicinal and phonetic (sound-based) elements, which bring us bliss. Moreover, this *Dhātu-Śabda Śakti* (root-sound power) belongs solely to human beings.

Conclusion of Method-11:
From RigVēda (1-34-6) we conclude that *Dhātu-Śabda Śakti* (root-sound power) belongs solely to human beings.

Method-12:
Vēdākshara power extends life.

RigVēda (1-10-11)
देवता: इन्द्रः ऋषि: मधुच्छन्दाः वैश्वामित्रः छन्द: अनुष्टुप् स्वर: गान्धारः
आ तू न इन्द्र कौशिक मन्दसानः सुतं पिब। नव्यमायुः प्र सू तिर कृधी सहस्रसामृषिम्॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-10-11):
O master skilled in the sacred dictionaries! O Indra! Protect well the one who was born for our sake. Surely, may sleep grant us a new life that is most beneficial and auspicious. With compassion, bestow upon us many sages.

Conclusion of Method-12:
According to RigVēda (1-10-11) *Akshara* power extends life.

Conclusion:
Vēdic language is the first complete language. From it, *Sanskrit* took shape. Yet, these two are distinct in form. The *Vēda Samhitas* are the only authoritative texts of the Vēdic language-there is no second scripture For the Vēdic language, the "Vēda Saṃhitā" is a single text. In the Vēdas, language is *"Vēdākshara-centered" (akshara-pradhāna,* while in ordinary languages, it is *"sound and root-centered" (Shabda-dhātu-pradhāna).* Through *the use of Vēdāksharas*, the vital life energy (*prāna shakti*) gains the

form of *speech (vāg-rupa).* Vēdāksharas are natural to living beings; words are human constructs. A Vēdākshara is expressed as sound through the vital breath (*prāna*). The birth of a Vēdākshara occurs where *life energy, vital energy, and sound energy* meet. The birth of a word occurs where *desire, feeling, and effort* converge. A Vēdākshara represents the inner vital power of the body. A word represents the external sensory experience. The power of Vēdāksharas is common to all living beings; the power of words and roots belongs only to humans. Vēdākshara power extends life.

References:

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(2). RigVēda (1-165-15).
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(4). RigVēda (10-125-4).
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(7). RigVēda (1-101-5).
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(11). RigVēda (1-34-6).
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